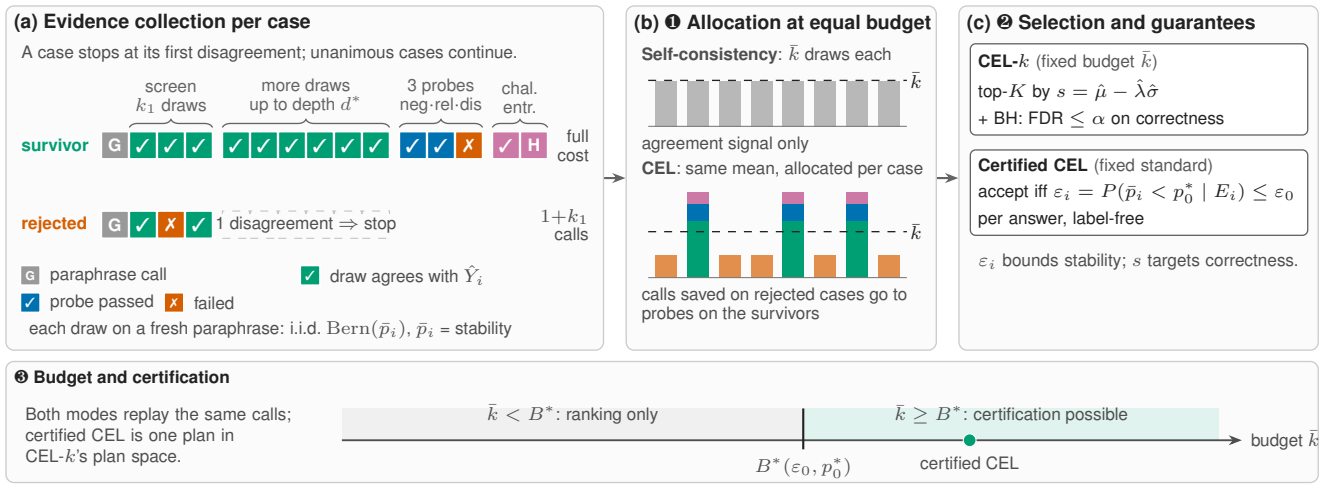

(a) Evidence collection per case
A case stops at its first disagreement; unanimous cases continue.
screen k_1 draws
more draws up to depth d^*
3 probes neg·rel·dis
chal. entr.
survivor
full cost
rejected
1 disagreement ⇒ stop
$1+k_1$ calls
paraphrase call
draw agrees with $\hat{Y}_i$
probe passed
failed
each draw on a fresh paraphrase: i.i.d. $\mathrm{Bern}(\bar{p}_i)$, $\bar{p}_i$ = stability
(b) ❶ Allocation at equal budget
Self-consistency: $\bar{k}$ draws each
$\bar{k}$
agreement signal only
CEL: same mean, allocated per case
$\bar{k}$
calls saved on rejected cases go to probes on the survivors
(c) ❷ Selection and guarantees
CEL-k (fixed budget $\bar{k}$)
top-K by $s = \hat{\mu} - \hat{\lambda}\hat{\sigma}$
+ BH: FDR $\leq \alpha$ on correctness
Certified CEL (fixed standard)
accept iff $\varepsilon_i = P(\bar{p}_i < p_0^* \mid E_i) \leq \varepsilon_0$
per answer, label-free
ε_i bounds stability; s targets correctness.
❸ Budget and certification
Both modes replay the same calls; certified CEL is one plan in CEL-k's plan space.
$\bar{k} < B^*$: ranking only
$\bar{k} \geq B^*$: certification possible
budget $\bar{k}$
$B^*(\varepsilon_0, p_0^*)$
certified CEL